



21-30 October 2008

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Committed to connecting the world

Objectives:

- Raise profile of Sector
- Attract high level participation and media interest
- Attract more countries to participate in work
- Identify new exciting and high profile areas of work
- Create an efficient study group structure, avoiding duplication and facilitating greater participation, especially from developing countries.
- Reduce the number of study groups - it leads to increased efficiency, less need to travel, less liaisons and duplication, all saving money for ITU and its membership.
- More co-located meetings, the establishment of more regional groups, more meetings in the regions, and the encouragement of greater use of remote participation.
- Make it an interesting and enjoyable event

Statistics:

- Five regional WTSA-08 preparatory meetings (Brazil, Ghana, Uzbekistan, Syria, Viet Nam) in association with Regional Development Forums on Bridging the Standards Gap, in collaboration with BR, BDT and Regional Offices
- Resulted in regional common proposals from five regions
- Total of 350 contributions
- 99 participating countries
- Over 1000 attendees
- 13 ministers/vice-ministers
- VIPs spanning the world and the ICT industry sector

WTSA-08

A first in many ways:



- 1st time chaired by a woman
 - Lyndall Shope-Mafole, Director-General, South African Ministry of Communications
- 1st time in Africa
- 1st time preceded by a Global Standards Symposium
- 1st time academia invited – tutorial held
- 1st time side events held
- 1st time associated exhibition
- 1st time term limits on chairmanships applied:
 - Virtually complete new team of chairmen and vice-chairmen (2 day tutorial being held today and tomorrow for them)
- Unprecedented media coverage
 - local and international: including 3 TV interviews, 3 radio interviews, and numerous printed articles and web coverage

First Global Standards Symposium



- Held 20 October 2008
- 500 participants
- Chaired by H.E. Mr Nguyen Thanh Hung, Vice-Minister, Ministry of Information and Communications, Viet Nam
- Speakers included ministers, ambassadors, heads of regulatory authorities, senior executives from the private sector, and heads of major standards bodies.
- At end of the day agreed a nine page report which was presented next day by the Chairman of GSS to the first Plenary of the WTSA-08 in ITU's six official languages.
- The conclusions addressed ways to bridge the standardization gap; challenges in the new standards landscape, including climate change and accessibility; and ways to strengthen collaboration amongst standards bodies.
- Conclusions acted on by WTSA-08

New work programme:

- Achieved a major restructuring and streamlining of the study groups
- The work of three of the study groups in previous period was reallocated to other study groups so that the total number of study groups was reduced to ten.
- Collocated meetings of ITU-T Study Groups 9 (Television and sound transmission and integrated broadband cable networks) and 16 (Multimedia coding, systems and applications) as well as Study Groups 11 (Signalling requirements, protocols and test specifications) and Study Group 13 (Future networks including mobile and NGN).
- Seven new study group chairmen and new TSAG chairman elected, bringing a fresh focus to existing and new work areas.
- A Standardization Committee for Vocabulary (SCV) was established

New work methods:

- WTSA-08 adopted 21 new Resolutions, revised 27 existing Resolutions, adopted two new Recommendations and revised 7 existing Recommendations
- A new [Resolution on ICTs and Climate Change](#) encourages the membership to work towards reductions in greenhouse gas in line with the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change
- Rules of procedure amended in order to ensure that ITU offers best place to address global telecoms/ICT standards: greater use of electronic working including remote participation.
- A new Resolution encourages more work in the field of telecommunication/ICT accessibility for persons with disabilities and to review the accessibility of ITU services and facilities.
- Another new Resolution calls on Director TSB to organize regular meetings for high-level industry executives in order to assist in identifying and coordinating standardization priorities and subjects, so as to minimize the number of forums and consortia, taking account of the needs of developing countries.

Internet related output:

- revised Recommendation ITU-T D.50 on International Internet Connectivity.
- A new Resolution on IP address allocation and encouraging the deployment of IPv6 calls for a study of the allocation and economic aspects of IP addresses, and to study possibility of TSB handling IPv6 address allocation and registration for interested members, especially developing countries, and to report to the 2009 session of the ITU Council.
- A new Resolution invites Member to refrain from taking any unilateral and/or discriminatory actions that could impede another Member State to access public Internet sites, within the spirit of article 1 of the ITU Constitution and WSIS principles and to report any such incident to TSB.
- A new Resolution calls for establishment of a dedicated group on international Internet-related public policy issues as an integral part of the Council WG on WSIS (Done)

Bridging the standards gap output:

- a number of results that will facilitate greater participation of developing countries in the standards work of ITU.
- A strong starting point was achieved for the development of a possible future ITU Mark – intended as a voluntary program that will permit manufacturers and service providers to make a visible declaration that their equipment conforms to ITU-T Recommendations. TSB Director to study implications and report to 2009 session of Council
- a new Resolution to encourage the creation of national Computer Incident Response Teams (CIRTs), particularly for developing countries
- A new Recommendation on network externalities (ITU-T D.156) was approved but a number of countries placed reservations with respect to this Recommendation.

Financial considerations for Council/PP-10:

- A reduced fee for admission to ITU-T of academic institutions, universities and their associated research establishments particularly academic institutions of developing and least developed countries
- Admission of new members to ITU-T from developing countries equal to those levels applied to developing countries when admitted to the Study Groups in ITU-D
- Financial implications of the decisions and Resolutions adopted by WTSA-08 estimated at CHF 2.1 million per biennium, not including cost of implementing accessibility of ITU and ITU-T services and facilities for persons with disabilities,

Conclusions:

- ITU's role as the world's pre-eminent global ICT standards body strengthened
- Bridging the standardization gap recognised as essential to ITU's mission to Connect the World
- A streamlined and efficient study group structure adopted avoiding duplication and focusing on key objectives
- New team of chairmen and vice-chairmen from 33 countries
- Excellent team work of ITU staff involved in Johannesburg and Geneva: General Secretariat and TSB, as well as BR, BDT and the Regional Office
- First SG15 meeting since WTSA-08 was completely paperless, had largest ever participation (367 delegates) largest ever number of contributions (336) consented 28 Recommendations including new high profile global standard on home networking:
 - PC World (US) 13.12.08: "The powerful world standards organization ...[ITU].. has reached agreement on G.hn a set of specifications that would encompass phone lines, power lines, and coaxial cable to provide HDTV room to room..."
- Full list of WTSA Resolutions is at: <http://www.itu.int/publ/T-RES/e>